Coaching Codex

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COACHING CODEX · GUIDE 01 · AI PROMPTING

50 Copy-Paste AI Prompts for Small Business Owners

Ready-made prompts for marketing, sales, customer service, admin and planning. Fill in the brackets, paste, done. No tech skills needed.

50
prompts across 5 business areas

C.R.A.F.T.
a formula to write your own

7 days
challenge + safety checklists

START HERE

Welcome. Let AI do the first draft, so you can do the thinking.

This guide gives you 50 ready-made prompts for the jobs small business owners do every week: writing posts, answering customers, chasing payments, planning, hiring and more. You do not need any technical skills. If you can type a message, you can use every page of this guide.

50
Copy-paste prompts
Grouped into five areas of your business, ready to use.

1
Simple formula
The C.R.A.F.T. method for writing your own prompts.

7
Day challenge
A short daily practice so AI becomes a habit.

What's inside

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HOW TO USE THE PROMPTS

Open any AI chat assistant (for example ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Microsoft Copilot). Copy a prompt, replace everything in [BRACKETS] with your own details, and send. Then reply with follow-ups like **"shorter"**, **"friendlier"** or **"give me 3 more options"**. The first answer is a draft, not the final word.

SECTION 01 · THE FORMULA

The C.R.A.F.T. formula: better answers in five parts

Most disappointing AI answers come from short, vague requests. Give the assistant the same briefing you would give a new team member, and the quality jumps.

Letter	Means	Ask yourself	Example
C	Context	What is my business and situation?	"I run a 3-person bakery in a busy neighbourhood."
R	Role	Who should the AI act as?	"Act as an experienced local marketing consultant."
A	Ask	What exactly do I want?	"Write 5 ideas for a weekend promotion."
F	Format	How should the answer look?	"A numbered list, max 2 sentences each."
T	Tone	How should it sound?	"Warm, simple, no jargon."

MASTER TEMPLATE · C.R.A.F.T.

Context: I run **[TYPE OF BUSINESS]** in **[CITY/AREA]**. My customers are mostly **[WHO THEY ARE]**.
Role: Act as **[EXPERT ROLE, e.g. a friendly marketing consultant]**.
Ask: **[WHAT YOU WANT, e.g. give me 5 ideas to bring in more customers on quiet weekdays]**.
Format: **[e.g. a numbered list with a one-line reason for each]**.
Tone: **[e.g. practical and simple, no jargon]**.
Before you answer, ask me up to 3 questions if anything important is missing.

Three follow-ups that fix almost any answer

"Make it shorter"

Ask for half the length, or a strict word limit.

"Give me options"

Ask for 3 versions, then pick and mix the best parts.

"Sound like me"

Paste a message you wrote and ask it to match your style.

EXERCISE 1 · UPGRADE A WEAK PROMPT (5 MINUTES)

Take this weak prompt: **"Write a Facebook post about my shop."** Rewrite it using all five C.R.A.F.T. parts, then send both versions to your AI assistant and compare the results. Note down which version you would actually post.

SECTION 02 · PROMPTS 1–10

Marketing & content

Fill your social feeds, website and newsletter without staring at a blank page.

1. **Post ideas:** Give me 15 social media post ideas for [BUSINESS] that would interest [TARGET CUSTOMER]. Mix tips, behind-the-scenes, customer stories and offers.
2. **Caption writer:** Write 3 Instagram captions for a photo of [DESCRIBE PHOTO]. Tone: [TONE]. Include one question to get comments and up to 5 relevant hashtags.
3. **Promotion:** Create a short promotion for [PRODUCT/SERVICE] running [DATES]. Give me a catchy name, a 2-line description and 3 ways to announce it.
4. **Website 'About' page:** Write a friendly About Us section for [BUSINESS]. Facts: [FOUNDED, WHO YOU ARE, WHAT MAKES YOU DIFFERENT]. Max 150 words.
5. **Product description:** Write a product description for [PRODUCT]. Key features: [FEATURES]. Focus on benefits for [CUSTOMER]. Give a short and a long version.
6. **Newsletter:** Draft a short monthly email newsletter for [BUSINESS] covering: [NEWS 1], [NEWS 2], [OFFER]. Add a subject line and one clear call to action.
7. **Repurpose:** Turn this text into a LinkedIn post, an Instagram caption and a 30-second video script: [PASTE TEXT].
8. **Review reply (public):** Write a warm public reply to this customer review. Thank them and mention [DETAIL]: [PASTE REVIEW].
9. **Local visibility:** Suggest 10 simple, low-cost ways for a [BUSINESS TYPE] in [CITY] to get noticed by local customers, online and offline.
10. **Content calendar:** Create a 4-week content calendar for [BUSINESS] with 3 posts per week. Show it as a table: week, day, topic, format, caption idea.

EXAMPLE · PROMPT #1 FILLED IN

Give me 15 social media post ideas for my family-run bakery in Petaling Jaya that would interest busy office workers nearby. Mix tips, behind-the-scenes, customer stories and offers.

PRO TIP

Save your best answers in a single document called "Brand Voice". Next time, paste it in and say "write in this style" for instantly more on-brand results.

SECTION 03 · PROMPTS 11–20

Sales & winning customers

Write offers, follow-ups and pitches that sound professional and get replies.

11 **Sales email:** Write a short email introducing [PRODUCT/SERVICE] to [TYPE OF CLIENT]. Focus on their problem: [PROBLEM]. Under 120 words, end with a simple question.

12 **Follow-up:** Write a polite follow-up to a customer who received my quote for [SERVICE] [X DAYS] ago and has not replied. Make it easy to say yes or no.

13 **Objection handling:** Customers often say "[OBJECTION, e.g. it's too expensive]". Give me 5 honest, friendly ways to respond, with an example sentence for each.

14 **Elevator pitch:** Write 3 versions of a 20-second pitch for [BUSINESS]: one casual, one professional, one for networking events.

15 **Ideal customer:** Based on this description of my best customers, [DESCRIBE], create a simple customer profile: needs, worries, where they spend time online, what convinces them.

16 **Quote / proposal:** Turn these notes into a clear one-page proposal with scope, timeline, price and next steps: [PASTE NOTES].

17 **Upsell ideas:** I sell [MAIN PRODUCT]. Suggest 8 add-ons, bundles or upgrades my customers would genuinely find useful.

18 **Win-back:** Write a friendly message to customers who have not bought in [TIME PERIOD]. Include a reason to come back: [OFFER OR NEWS].

19 **Referral ask:** Write a short, non-pushy message asking happy customers to recommend us to a friend. Mention [REFERRAL REWARD, if any].

20 **Testimonial request:** Write a message asking [CUSTOMER NAME] for a short testimonial, with 3 simple questions they can answer in 2 minutes.

EXAMPLE · PROMPT #11 FILLED IN

Write a short email introducing our office cleaning service to small accounting firms. Focus on their problem: no time to manage cleaners during tax season. Under 120 words, end with a simple question.

PRO TIP

Ask the AI to "role-play as a sceptical customer" and practise your pitch in the chat. It's a free, judgement-free rehearsal partner.

SECTION 04 · PROMPTS 21–30

Customer service

Reply faster, stay calm in tricky situations, and keep customers coming back.

21 **Reply draft:** Draft a helpful, friendly reply to this customer message. Our policy is [POLICY]. Keep it under 100 words: [PASTE MESSAGE].

22 **Angry customer:** This customer is upset: [PASTE MESSAGE]. Write a calm reply that acknowledges their feelings, explains what happened and offers [SOLUTION].

23 **FAQ builder:** List the 15 questions customers of a [BUSINESS TYPE] most often ask, with short, clear answers based on these facts: [YOUR FACTS].

24 **Saying no nicely:** Write a kind but firm reply declining this request: [REQUEST]. Offer an alternative: [ALTERNATIVE].

25 **Delay notice:** Write a message telling customers their [ORDER/SERVICE] will be delayed by [TIME] because of [REASON]. Apologise and offer [GESTURE].

26 **Quick replies:** Create 10 short saved replies (max 2 sentences each) for common chat questions about [TOPICS, e.g. opening hours, delivery, prices].

27 **Welcome message:** Write a welcome message for new customers explaining what happens next, how to contact us and one helpful tip about [PRODUCT].

28 **Policy in plain words:** Rewrite our [REFUND/DELIVERY/BOOKING] policy in simple, friendly language a customer can read in 30 seconds: [PASTE POLICY].

29 **Feedback survey:** Create a 5-question customer feedback survey for [BUSINESS]. Mix rating and open questions. Keep it under 2 minutes to complete.

30 **Bad review response:** Write a professional public reply to this negative review. Don't argue; invite them to continue privately at [CONTACT]: [PASTE REVIEW].

EXAMPLE · PROMPT #21 FILLED IN

Draft a helpful, friendly reply to this customer message. Our policy is free exchange within 14 days with receipt. Keep it under 100 words: "Hi, the shoes I bought are too small, can I change them?"

PRO TIP

Remove names, phone numbers, order IDs and other personal details before pasting customer messages into an AI tool. Replace them with [CUSTOMER] or [ORDER].

SECTION 05 · PROMPTS 31–40

Operations, money & admin

Turn messy notes into clean documents and save hours of admin every month.

31 **Process checklist:** Turn this description of how we [TASK] into a step-by-step checklist a new staff member could follow: [DESCRIBE].

32 **Meeting summary:** Summarise these meeting notes into decisions, action items (who / what / by when) and open questions: [PASTE NOTES].

33 **Payment reminder:** Write a polite payment reminder for invoice [NUMBER] of [AMOUNT], due on [DATE]. Version 1 friendly, version 2 firmer.

34 **Supplier email:** Write an email to [SUPPLIER] asking for [BETTER PRICE / FASTER DELIVERY / NEW TERMS]. Be polite and give one clear reason.

35 **Spreadsheet formula:** In [EXCEL/GOOGLE SHEETS], I have [DESCRIBE COLUMNS]. Give me a formula to [WHAT YOU WANT], and explain it in plain words.

36 **Expense sorting:** Sort these expenses into sensible categories and show totals per category in a table: [PASTE LIST].

37 **Simple budget:** Create a simple monthly budget template for a [BUSINESS TYPE] with typical income and cost lines. Show it as a table I can copy.

38 **Job description:** Write a clear, friendly job ad for a [ROLE] at [BUSINESS]. Include duties, must-have skills, nice-to-haves and how to apply.

39 **Interview questions:** Give me 10 interview questions for a [ROLE], including 3 that reveal attitude and reliability, with what a good answer sounds like.

40 **Standard email templates:** Write 5 reusable email templates for [COMMON SITUATIONS, e.g. booking confirmation, rescheduling, thank you].

EXAMPLE · PROMPT #31 FILLED IN

Write a polite payment reminder for invoice 1042 of USD 850, due on 15 March. Version 1 friendly, version 2 firmer.

PRO TIP

AI can make mistakes with numbers. Always double-check totals, formulas and dates before you send anything to a customer, supplier or accountant.

SECTION 06 · PROMPTS 41–50

Strategy, planning & you

Use AI as a thinking partner for big decisions and for protecting your own time.

41 **SWOT:** Do a simple SWOT analysis for [BUSINESS] based on these facts: [FACTS]. Then suggest the 3 most important actions.

42 **Competitor check:** Here is what I know about my competitors: [DESCRIBE]. How can I stand out? Give 5 practical ideas.

43 **Pricing ideas:** I sell [PRODUCT] at [PRICE]. My costs are about [COSTS]. Suggest pricing options (bundles, tiers, packages) and the pros and cons of each.

44 **90-day plan:** My goal is [GOAL] in the next 90 days. Break it into monthly milestones and weekly actions for a business with [TEAM SIZE] people.

45 **New idea test:** I'm thinking about [NEW PRODUCT/SERVICE]. Ask me 10 tough questions to test whether it's a good idea before I invest.

46 **Decision helper:** I need to choose between [OPTION A] and [OPTION B]. Compare them in a table on cost, risk, time and impact, then give a recommendation.

47 **Weekly plan:** Here are my tasks for this week: [LIST]. Organise them by priority and suggest what to delegate, automate or drop.

48 **Explain it simply:** Explain [TOPIC, e.g. profit margin / SEO / cash flow] like I'm a busy shop owner, with one real-life example.

49 **Learning plan:** Create a 2-week plan to learn the basics of [SKILL], using free resources and 20 minutes a day.

50 **Monthly review:** Ask me 8 questions to review my business month: what worked, what didn't, and what to change next month. Ask one question at a time.

EXAMPLE · PROMPT #41 FILLED IN

My goal is 20 new monthly subscribers for my meal-prep service in the next 90 days. Break it into monthly milestones and weekly actions for a business with 2 people.

PRO TIP

Prompt 50 is a great end-of-month ritual. Answer honestly, then ask: "Based on my answers, what are my top 3 priorities for next month?"

SECTION 07 · PRACTICE

Your 7-day prompt challenge

Fifteen minutes a day for one week. By day seven, using AI will feel as normal as sending a text message.

Day	Do this	Prompts	Done
1	Write your C.R.A.F.T. “business intro” paragraph and save it in a note.	Master template	
2	Plan next week’s social posts and write 3 captions.	#1, #2, #10	
3	Follow up with one customer or lead you’ve been meaning to contact.	#12, #18	
4	Build your top-10 FAQ answers and quick replies.	#23, #26	
5	Turn one messy process into a checklist for your team.	#31, #32	
6	Test one new idea or price change with the AI as your critic.	#43, #45	
7	Review the week, pick your 10 favourite prompts, save them.	#50	

Build your personal prompt library

Copy your best prompts (with your details already filled in) into one document or notes app. Use this simple structure:

Prompt name	When I use it	My version (with my details)

EXERCISE 2 · YOUR FIRST WIN

Pick **one** task you did last week that took more than 30 minutes (an email, a post, a document). Redo it today with a prompt from this guide. Write down roughly how long it took this time: _____ minutes.

SECTION 08 · CHECKLISTS

Before you hit “send”: quality & safety checklists

AI is a fast assistant, not a final authority. Run through these lists every time you use AI-written text with customers.

Quality check

- [ ] Facts, prices, dates and names are correct
- [ ] It sounds like **you**, not like a robot
- [ ] It’s short enough to read on a phone
- [ ] There is one clear next step for the reader
- [ ] No promises you can’t keep
- [ ] Spelling of product and place names is right
- [ ] You would be happy if a competitor read it

Safety & privacy check

- [ ] No customer names, phone numbers or IDs pasted in
- [ ] No passwords, bank details or private contracts
- [ ] Sensitive business numbers removed or rounded
- [ ] Legal, medical or tax content checked by a professional
- [ ] Images and claims don’t copy other brands
- [ ] You’ve checked the tool’s data and privacy settings
- [ ] A human reads it before customers do

IMPORTANT

AI tools can sound confident and still be wrong. Treat every answer as a first draft. For anything involving money, law, health or contracts, use AI to prepare questions, then confirm with a qualified person.

When an answer isn’t good enough

Problem	Try this follow-up
Too generic	“Use my details: [PASTE FACTS]. Remove anything generic.”
Too long	“Cut this to 60 words. Keep the key message.”
Wrong tone	“Rewrite in a warmer, more casual tone, like talking to a regular customer.”
Not sure it’s right	“Which parts of your answer are you least sure about? What should I double-check?”

WHAT'S NEXT

You've got the prompts. Now build the systems.

Prompts save minutes. Systems save hours every week. Each Coaching Codex guide takes one job in your business and turns it into a simple, repeatable AI routine.

Write a Week of Social Media Posts in 30 Minutes with AI

A step-by-step system: brand brief, content pillars, 7 posts, platform versions and scheduling.

Automate Your Inbox and Customer Replies with AI

Sort, draft and automate customer emails and chats, with a human always in control.

AI Spreadsheets for Non-Techies

Formulas, clean-up and simple reports, explained in plain words.

No-Code Automation Starter Kit

Connect your apps with tools like Zapier, Make or n8n, no coding needed.

Explore the Coaching Codex library →

Each guide comes with a free video walkthrough. Find the full library, bundles and new releases on the Coaching Codex website and our YouTube, TikTok and Instagram channels.

Share your first win

Tried a prompt that saved you time? Tell us what worked. The best ideas from readers shape future guides.

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